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United States Patent	12405095
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
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Adjustable carrier device

Abstract

A carrier device includes a body member having two parallel sections, terminal ends of which extend in a common direction. A bracket nested with the body member has two lateral side members extending in the common direction. Each side member has a terminal end and a loop proximate the end defining a hole. An interior is defined between the sections of the body member and between the side members of the bracket. A binding member engages the sections of the body member and passes through the respective hole of each side member defined by the loop. A retention member, for retaining a magazine when inserted into the carrier device, also passes through the respective holes. The binding member draws sections of the body member toward each other to maintain frictional engagement of an inserted magazine or other article with interior contact points of the carrier device.

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Appl. No.: **18/466273**

Filed: **September 13, 2023**

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230417523 A1	Dec. 28, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 18146129 20221223 US 11835327 child-doc US 18466273

continuation parent-doc US 17519155 20211104 US 11536550 20221227 child-doc US 18146129

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **F42B39/02** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **F42B39/02** (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A45F (2200/0591); A45F (5/00); A45F (5/02); A45F (5/021); A45F (3/06); F42B (39/02); F41C (33/04); F41C (33/00337); F41C (33/0209); F41C (33/0236)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. non-provisional patent application Ser. No. 18/146,129, titled “ADJUSTABLE CARRIER DEVICE,” filed on Dec. 23, 2022, which is a continuation of U.S. non-provisional patent application Ser. No. 17/519,155, titled “ADJUSTABLE CARRIER DEVICE,” filed on Nov. 4, 2021, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,536,550 issued on Dec. 27, 2022, each of which is hereby incorporated in their entireties by this reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD
(1) The present disclosure relates to devices for carrying articles. More particularly, the present disclosure relates to an adjustable carrier device for an ammunition magazine.
BACKGROUND
(2) Ammunition magazine carrying pouches are typically fabric walled and can thus be used to carry various types of articles by conforming somewhat to any inserted article. While such flexibility is useful, in order to secure a carried article, some sort of manually released closure means is needed. For example, a closure flap may overlay the opening of the pouch to secure an enclosed article, with the flap being secured in a closed configuration with a button or hook-and-loop fabric patches. An entirely soft-walled pouch surrounded by a cinching cord may collapse when emptied, and may gather at its opening. Thus typical ammunition carrying pouches may delay access to ammunition or other carried article at a critical moment.
(3) Hard-shell carriers, on the other hand, are typically less flexible as to their use, and may be sized and shaped for a specific article type. While a hard-shell carrier having fixed dimensions such as a box may not collapse when empty, a manually released closure means may be needed as with a soft-walled pouch. Thus, again, access to a needed article such as an ammunition magazine may be delayed at a critical moment as the closure is manually released.
SUMMARY
(4) This summary is provided to briefly introduce concepts that are further described in the following detailed descriptions. This summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it to be construed as limiting the scope of the claimed subject matter.
(5) In at least one embodiment, a carrier device includes: a body member including a first section, a second section parallel to the first section, and a central section to which the first section and second section are attached, the first section and second section each having a terminal end, the terminal end of the first section and the terminal end of the second section extending away from the

central section in a common direction. A bracket includes a central base plate, a first lateral side member attached to a first end of central base plate, and a second lateral side member attached to a second end of central base plate, the first lateral side member and second lateral side member each having a respective terminal end and a respective loop proximate the respective terminal end defining a respective hole, the terminal end of the first lateral side member and the terminal end of the second lateral side member extending away from the base plate in the common direction, wherein the bracket is nested with the body member with the base plate proximate the central section such that an interior of the carrier device is defined between the first section and second section of the body member and between the first lateral side member and second lateral side member. A binding member engages the first section and the second section, the binding member passing through each said respective hole defined by said respective loop of the first lateral side member and second lateral side member of the frame. A retention member, for retaining a magazine when inserted into the carrier device, has a respective portion passing through each said respective hole defined by said respective loop of the first lateral side member and second lateral side member of the frame.

(6) The terminal ends of the lateral side members may extend in the common direction beyond the terminal ends of the first section and second section of the body member.

(7) The terminal ends of the lateral side members and the terminal ends of the first section and second section of the body member may together define an opening into the interior of the carrier device.

(8) The respective terminal end of each lateral side member may include a ramped inward contact surface such that the opening into the interior of the carrier device is tapered.

(9) The respective terminal end of each of the first section and second section of the body member may include a ramped inward contact surface.

(10) An upper tip of the loop of each lateral side member may define the terminal end thereof.

(11) An interior face of the loop of each lateral side member may define the ramped inward contact surface thereof.

(12) A laterally outward portion of the loop of each lateral side member may extend generally parallel to the side member thereby defining the hole as an elongate slot.

(13) Each lateral side member, along an exterior side thereof, may include at least one pair of parallel spaced ribs.

(14) A portion of the binding member may be held in a space between the ribs by at least on other portion of the binding member.

(15) The ribs may have alternating high portions and low portions to guide the binding member.

(16) Each lateral side member, along an exterior side thereof, may include multiple pairs of parallel spaced ribs, wherein each pairs is spaced from at least one other by a gap that receives a respective portion of the binder member.

(17) The body member may be a unitary materially contiguous item of which the first section, second section and central section are materially contiguous portions.

(18) The body member may include polymer.

(19) The first section of the body member may include hooks for releasably engaging the binding member.

(20) The second section of the body member may include hooks for releasably engaging the binding member.

(21) The body member may include a flexible and foldable rectangular assembly comprising fabric.

(22) The body member may include multiple band portions attached to the first section defining loops to engage respective portions of the binding member.

(23) The body member may include bands attached to the second section to engage respective portions of the binding member.

(24) The binding member may include a stretchable cord having an adjustable loop portion and an

adjuster.
(25) The above summary is to be understood as cumulative and inclusive. The above described embodiments and features are combined in various combinations in whole or in part in one or more other embodiments.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS
(1) The previous summary and the following detailed descriptions are to be read in view of the drawings, which illustrate particular exemplary embodiments and features as briefly described below. The summary and detailed descriptions, however, are not limited to only those embodiments and features explicitly illustrated.
(2) FIG. **1**A is a front view of a carrier device, according to at least one embodiment, shown carrying a magazine, for example for a pistol.
(3) FIG. **1**B is a perspective view of upper portions of the device and magazine of FIG. **1**.
(4) FIG. **1**C is a side view of the device and magazine of FIG. **1** with a top retention member removed.
(5) FIG. **2**A shows the outward side of an unfolded body member of the device of FIG. **1** in perspective view.
(6) FIG. **2**B shows the outward side of the body member of FIG. **2**A in plan view.
(7) FIG. **2**C shows the inward side of the body member of FIG. **2**A in perspective view.
(8) FIG. **3**A is a front view of a bracket for the carrier device of FIG. **1**.
(9) FIG. **3**B is a side view of the bracket of FIG. **3**A.
(10) FIG. **3**C is a bottom view of the bracket of FIG. **3**A.
(11) FIG. **3**D is a perspective view of the bracket of FIG. **3**A.
(12) FIG. **4** is a cross-sectional view of the body member taken along the line **4-4** in FIG. **3**C.
(13) FIG. **5** shows a binding member and adjuster thereof separated from the device of FIG. **1**.
(14) FIG. **6** is a perspective view of a bracket, according to another embodiment, for example for use in a carrier device for a rifle magazine.
(15) FIG. **7**A is a perspective view of the outward side of an unfolded body member, according to at least one embodiment, for example for use in a carrier device with the bracket of FIG. **6**.
(16) FIG. **7**B is a perspective view of the inward side of the body member of FIG. **7**A.
(17) FIG. **8** is a perspective view of a bracket, according to another embodiment, for example for use in a carrier device for a rifle magazine.
(18) FIG. **9** is a plan view of an unfolded body member, according to at least one other embodiment, for example for use in a carrier device with the bracket of FIG. **8**.
(19) FIG. **10**A is a front of a carrier device, according to at least one embodiment, incorporating the bracket of FIG. **8** and the body member of FIG. **9**.
(20) FIG. **10**B is a back view of the carrier device and magazine of FIG. **10**A.
(21) FIG. **10**C is a side view of the carrier device and magazine of FIG. **9**A.
(22) FIG. **11** is a perspective view of a bracket, according to another embodiment with similarities to that of FIG. **8**, for example for use in a carrier device for a pistol magazine.
(23) FIG. **12** is a perspective view of a bracket, according to another embodiment with similarities to that of FIG. **11**, for example for use in a carrier device for a pistol magazine with extended capacity.
DETAILED DESCRIPTIONS
(24) These descriptions are presented with sufficient details to provide an understanding of one or more particular embodiments of broader inventive subject matters. These descriptions expound upon and exemplify particular features of those particular embodiments without limiting the

inventive subject matters to the explicitly described embodiments and features. Considerations in view of these descriptions will likely give rise to additional and similar embodiments and features without departing from the scope of the inventive subject matters. Although steps may be expressly described or implied relating to features of processes or methods, no implication is made of any particular order or sequence among such expressed or implied steps unless an order or sequence is explicitly stated.

(25) Any dimensions expressed or implied in the drawings and these descriptions are provided for exemplary purposes. Thus, not all embodiments within the scope of the drawings and these descriptions are made according to such exemplary dimensions. The drawings are not made necessarily to scale. Thus, not all embodiments within the scope of the drawings and these descriptions are made according to the apparent scale of the drawings with regard to relative dimensions in the drawings. However, for each drawing, at least one embodiment is made according to the apparent relative scale of the drawing.

(26) Like reference numbers used throughout the drawings depict like or similar elements. Unless described or implied as exclusive alternatives, features throughout the drawings and descriptions should be taken as cumulative, such that features expressly associated with some particular embodiments can be combined with other embodiments.

(27) A carrier device **100** according to at least one embodiment is shown in FIG. **1**A with an ammunition magazine **50** inserted and retained by the device. Magazines are available in a variety of sizes and configurations for many types of ammunition and firearms. The carrier device **100** accordingly can vary in particular dimensions. The magazine **50** particularly shown in FIG. **1**A is for ammunition typically used in a semiautomatic handgun, and thus the carrier device **100** of FIG. **1**A can be described as suited for use with a pistol without limitation as to other uses.

(28) In use as shown in FIG. **1**A, a magazine **50** is inserted into an open first end **102** of the device **100**. The open first end **102** may be for example oriented as upward in use. However, due to the magazine retention capability of the device, users may prefer various carrying strategies in which other orientations are utilized. A second end **104** of the device, opposite the first end, is generally closed with regard to insertion or passage of the magazine **50** or other carried articles, such that full insertion of a magazine is registered when the ammunition-feed end of the magazine reaches the of the second end **104** of the device **100**. At full insertion, the floor plate end **52** of the magazine extends outward from the first end **102** as available to be grasped and pulled from the carrier device **100**. Advantageously ramped inward contact surfaces **106** and **108** define a tapered opening **110** into the interior of the carrier device **100**, to receive the magazine **50** or other article, and that narrows to guide the magazine or article to proper alignment and insertion.

(29) A first exterior surface **112** (FIG. **1**A) of the carrier device **100** may be generally directed outward when the carrier device is mounted on a host such as a belt, strap, vest, harness, or pack, such as a MOLLE-equipped host item or apparel, referring to Modular Lightweight Load-carrying Equipment (MOLLE) having spaced mounting straps. In such use, a second exterior surface **114** (FIG. **1**C), opposite the first exterior surface **112**, would be generally directed toward such a host. A mounting strap **56**, for example attached to the second exterior surface **114**, may be provided as an accessory for attaching the carrier device **100** to a host.

(30) Retention of the magazine **50** by the carrier device **100** against unintended removal, for example as a user or gear on which the device is mounted moves about, is assured by the elastically self-adjusting performance of the carrier device. A binding member **120** is stretched among front, side, and back panels of the device **100** thereby adjustably circumferentially tightening the device around the magazine to maintain frictional engagement of an inserted magazine with interior contact points of the carrier device. This frictionally secures an inserted magazine while permitting sliding entry and removal of the magazine by force applied by hand at the outward extending end of the magazine, such as the floor plate end **52** of the magazine.

(31) The first exterior surface **112** and opposite second exterior surface **114** of the carrier device

100 in the illustrated embodiment are defined by the outer surfaces of corresponding sections of a unitary materially contiguous body member **130** (FIGS. **2**A-**2**C) when folded as in the assembled device **100** (FIG. **1**A). A first section of the body member **130** defines a front or first panel **132** of the assembled carrier device **100**, and a second section of the body member **130** defines a back or second panel **134** of the assembled carrier device **100**. Front and back are nominal terms referring to some expected uses of the carrier device **100** without limiting the carrier device **100** in its construction or use.

(32) The first panel **132** and second panel **134** are each attached to a central base section **136** (FIG. **2**B) of the body member **130**. The first panel **132** extends from a flexible first strip portion **140** of the base section **136** to a first terminal end **142** of the body member **130**. The second panel **134** extends from a flexible second strip portion **140** of the base section **136** to a second terminal end **144** of the body member **130**. The terminal ends **142**,**144** (FIG. **2**B) extend in opposite directions from the base section **136** in the unfolded condition. When the first panel **132** and second panel **134** are folded into approximately parallel condition as in the assembled carrier device **100** (FIG. **1**A), the terminal ends **142**,**144** extend in a common longitudinal direction and define, in cooperation with the bracket **200** as described below, the first end **102** of the device. The folding of the body member **130** is effected as flexure, at least or particularly, of the flexible strip portions **140**, which are connected by a rigidified base plate **146** (FIG. **2**B) that defines the second end **104** of the assembled carrier device **100** (FIG. **1**A).

(33) Contours and operative features of the body member **130** rigidify the first panel **132**, second panel **134**, and base plate **146**. For example, with reference to rigidifying contours of the body member **130**, the inward side **133** of the first panel **132** has an inside channel **150** (FIG. **2**C), extending longitudinally from the first terminal end **142** to the first strip portion **140** of the base section **136**, defined between lateral edges **152** of the first panel **132**. Longitudinal ridges **154** extend inward in laterally spaced pairs from the inward side **133** of the first panel **132** further add rigidity and provide frictional engagement with a magazine **50** or other article within the carrier as represented in FIG. **4**.

(34) The inward side **135** (FIG. **2**C) of the second panel **134**, which faces the inward side **133** of the first panel **132** in the assembled carrier device, has an inside recess **156** defined between its lateral edges **153**, and several inward extending bosses **160** to provide further frictional engagement with a magazine or other article on an opposite side of the article relative to the ridges of the first panel **132**. Multiple holes **162** (FIG. **2**A) for passage and retention of the binding member **120** are defined through the second panel **134** along the periphery of the recess **156**. Mounting holes **164** for receiving fasteners such as screws are defined through outwardly planar portions of the second panel **134** opposite the recess **156**. The arrangement pattern of the holes **164** matches hole patterns in accessories such as the mounting strap **56** attached to the second panel **134** in FIG. **1**C by fasteners **58**.

(35) Along each lateral edge **152**, the first panel **132** has laterally inwardly directed hooks **170** defined by slots **180** formed through the first panel. Each hook **170**, at an end **176** thereof, has an inwardly extending tooth **172** (FIG. **4**) that retains a portion of the binding member **120** in the assembled carrier device **100**. An angled face **174** of the hook **170**, at the end **176** and opposite the tooth **172**, is angled inward away from the first exterior surface **112**. The end **176** of the hook **170** is thereby sunken relative to the first exterior surface **112** to protect the end of the hook from snagging on other objects. The angled face **174** is particularly advantageous in that, even if tension in the binding member **120** flexes the hook somewhat, the angled face **174** assures the end **176** of the hook remains sunken, approaches a flush disposition with the first exterior surface **112**, or is minimally exposed to any likelihood of snagging other objects. Each slot **180** is approximately U-shaped, having a longitudinally extending linear central slot portion **182** (FIG. **2**B), and a respective angled slot portion **184** at each end of the central slot portion, thereby defining an approximately trapezoidal hook **170** that has a base **178** (FIG. **4**) connected to a corresponding

lateral edge **152** and tapers therefrom to the end **176** of the hook. The hook **170**, from the base **178** to the verge of the angled face **174** is flush with the contours of the first exterior surface **112**.

(36) Along each lateral edge **153** thereof, the second panel **134** has a respective laterally inwardly directed hook **170** defined by slots **180** similarly as for the hooks **170** of the first panel **132**. Each hook **170** of the second panel **134**, however, in the illustrated embodiment does not have a tooth. The hook **170** retains a portion of the binding member **120** in the assembled carrier device **100**, and an angled face **174** of the hook opposite the tooth by which the end **176** of the hook is thereby sunken relative to the second exterior surface **114**. Each hook **170** is approximately trapezoidal, having a base **178** connected to a corresponding lateral edge **153** and tapering trapezoidally therefrom to the end **176** of the hook **170**.

(37) A laterally spaced pair of tabs **190** (FIG. **2**B) extend outward from the outward side of the base section **136** of the body member **130**. Each tab **190** has a laterally extending hole **192** for passage and retention of the binding member **120**. In the binding arrangement of the drawings, the adjuster **126** is nestled between the tabs when the binding member **120** is drawn taut.

(38) In the illustrated embodiments, the first panel **132** has an opposing first pair **194** of hooks proximal the first end **102** (FIG. **1**A, FIG. **2**A) and an opposing second pair **196** of hooks **170** proximal the second end **104** longitudinally spaced from the first pair **194**. The second panel **134** has an opposing pair of hooks **170**, referenced as the third pair **198** (FIG. **2**A) rearwardly offset from, and longitudinally positioned between, the first pair **194** and second pair **196** in the assembled carrier device **100**. By such placement of the pairs, the binding member **120** can be engaged in ordered succession such as the first pair **194**, the third pair **198**, and the second pair **196** along each lateral side of the carrier device **100** as in the illustrated binding arrangement.

(39) The binding member **120** is illustrated (FIG. **5**) as a stretchable cord **122** having one or more elastic strands forming a core covered in a woven fibrous sheath, for example made of polypropylene. Such binding members are known, for example, as shock cords and bungee cords. Opposite free ends **124** of the binding member extend from an adjuster **126** to define an adjustable loop portion **128** (FIG. **5**) of the binding member. The adjuster **126** is shown as a cord lock in the drawings. The adjustable loop portion **128** of the binding member **120** urges the interior of carrier device **100** upon a magazine or other carried article to maintain frictional engagement.

(40) Opposite lateral side members of the assembled carrier device **100** (FIG. **1**A) are provided by the bracket **200** shown in various views in FIGS. **3**A-**3**D. The bracket **200** includes a central base plate **202** and, attached to opposite respective lateral ends of the base plate, a first lateral side member **204** and a second lateral side member **204** that extend parallel to each other in a common longitudinal direction from the base plate. In the assembled carrier device **100**, the bracket **200** is nested within the body member **130** in the folded condition, with the exterior side of the base plate **202** of the bracket **200** abutting or proximate the interior side of the base plate **146** of the body member **130**.

(41) Respective terminal ends **206** of the side members **204**, in cooperation with the terminal ends **142** and **144** of the body member **130**, define the first end **102** of the assembled carrier device **100**. A respective ramped inward contact surface **108** adjacent the terminal end **206** of each side member **204** of the bracket **200** cooperates with the contact surfaces **106** to define the tapered opening **110** of the assembled carrier device **100**.

(42) FIG. **3**D includes reference to each of a lateral width dimension W (side-to-side), a longitudinal length dimension L (top-to-bottom), and a depth dimension D (front-to-back). These relate to FIG. **3**D, the bracket **200** thereof, and more generally to other drawings and structures thereof and their dimensions in respective relation to the W, L, and D dimensions of FIG. **3**D by association in the assembled carrier devices illustrated or implied herein. To be clear, the base plate **202** has a width in the width dimension W to accommodate a pistol magazine, whereas the base plate **402** has a greater width in the width dimension to accommodate a rifle magazine. Thus, the dimensions referenced in FIG. **3**D showing the bracket **200** of the carrier device **100** represent a

mutually orthogonal dimension set that is used herein to refer to other carrier devices and their components.
(43) Each lateral side member **204**, along an exterior side thereof, has a pair of parallel ribs **210** extending longitudinally from proximal the base plate toward the terminal end thereof. The ribs **210** are spaced from each other in the width dimension in that one rib **210** extends along a front edge of the side member **204** and a second rib extends along a back edge of the side member **204**. The ribs **210** rigidify the side members and provide guiding and retention of the binding member **120**. The ribs **210** have alternating high portions **212** and low portions **214** to guide and stabilize the binding member **120** in a binding arrangement with portions of the binding member received in the low portions. Particularly in the binding arrangement of the drawings (FIG. **1**C), the free ends **124** of the binding member **120** extending from the adjuster **126** are conveniently held in a space **218** (FIG. **3**B), which extends between the ribs **210**, under crossed portions of the adjustable loop portion of the binding member.
(44) Each lateral side member **204** has a loop **230** surrounding and defining a through opening **232** for passage and retention of the binding member **120**, for example as shown in FIG. **1**. The upper tip of the loop **230** defines the above-described terminal end **206** of the side member **204**, and an interior face of the loop defines the ramped inward contact surface **108**. The laterally outward portion **236** of the loop **230** extends, longitudinally in the length dimension, generally parallel to longitudinally extending side member **204**, thereby defining the opening **232** as an elongate slot having an internal length **238** (FIG. **3**A).
(45) The loop **230** and opening **232** thereof are dimensioned to receive multiple binding lines, for example as shown in FIG. **1**A, in which the elongated opening **232** at each lateral side of the carrier device **100** advantageously accommodates both the binding member **120** and the retention member **240**. In use, the retention member is passed over the floor plate end **52** of the magazine to further secure the inserted magazine in cooperation with the function of the binding member **120**, which tightens the device **100** around the magazine to apply frictional engagement as already described. Twists **242** may be applied in the retention member **240** to further increase the force applied by the member **240**, which pulls the magazine toward full insertion in the carrier device **100**. A user can stretch and position the member **240** over the end **52** to secure the inserted magazine or pull the retention member **240** aside when the magazine is wanted for use or other removal.
(46) Outer edges of the loop **230** and ribs **210** are generally beveled to minimize snagging or catching when carried with other gear. For example, thickness **228** of the loop, measured in the depth dimension, at the terminal end **206** is greater than the thickness **208** of lower portions of the side member **204**, such that upper end of the side member overall tapers from the thickness **228** at the terminal end **206** to a uniform lower thickness **208**. The tapering transition occurs along the ramped inward contact surface **108** such that the ramped inward contact surface **108** has the thickness **208** at the terminal end **206** and the thickness **228** at its base **248**. The laterally outward portion **236** of the loop **230** also tapers from the thickness **208** at the terminal end **206** to a lesser thickness as it extends downward from the end **206**.
(47) The retention member **240** is illustrated as a stretchable cord, for example having one or more elastic strands forming a core covered in a woven fibrous sheath, for example made of polypropylene. Such binding members are known, for example, as shock cords and bungee cords. The retention member **240** may be formed as a continuous loop by fusing terminal ends of a length of such cod material, or may be knotted form a loop.
(48) Each lateral side member **204**, at its junction with the central base **202**, has an arcuate laterally outwardly extending shoulder **220** in which a notch **222** is defined. The shoulders **220**, in cooperation with proximal low portions of the ribs, guide and stabilize the binding member **120** in a binding arrangement, for example as shown in FIGS. **1**A and **1**C. Either notch **222** can further guide and stabilize the binding member **120** by receiving portions of the free ends **124** proximate the adjuster **126** according to which side of bracket **200** the free ends are placed in the space **218**

(FIG. **3**B) between ribs **210** and under crossed portions of the binder member **120** as exemplified in FIG. **1**C.

(49) In the binding arrangement of the drawings, the binding member **120** is retained by its passage through holes **162** in the second panel **134**, openings **192** at the base plate **146** of the body member **130**, and openings **232** of the loops **230** of the bracket **200**. The binder member **120** also engages the hooks in both the first panel **132** and second panel **134**. Advantageously, the engagement of the binding member **120** with the first panel **132** is by way of the first pair **194** and second pair **196** of hooks **170** without passing through any hole in the first panel **132**. By this advantageous feature, the first panel **132** can be disengaged from the binding member **120** without necessitating delacing of the carrier device overall. Such disengagement can, for example, permit opening of the carrier device by hinging the first panel **132** relative to the second panel **134** by flexure of the strip portions **140** of the base section **136** as a living hinge. By such disengagement, the carrier device **100** can be effectively opened for inspection, clearing, or cleaning. Re-engagement can be achieved by re-hooking the binding member **120** in any preferred binding arrangement. In the illustrated binding arrangement, a twist is introduced in the binding member **120** when engaging the third pair **198** of hooks **170** (FIG. **2**A) to effect the crossed portions **121** illustrated in FIG. **1**A. Low portions of the ribs in each of side members are positioned longitudinally in alignment with the third hooks to receive such crossed portions **121** conveniently.

(50) Even where adjustment of the carrier device **100** is wanted without opening, use of the hooks **170**, instead of holes, permit considerable convenience and ease in adjusting the binding member **120**, avoids kinks, and facilitates tension uniformity along the serpentine path of the loop portion of the binding member **120** in any binding arrangement that utilizes the hooks. The hooks further serve to avoid full winding of the binding member **120** around the first panel **132** and second panel **134**. The binding member **120** in the illustrated binding engagement with the hooks is sunken within the slots **180** and under the hooks **170** relative to the first exterior surface **112** and second exterior surface **114**. This protects the binding member **120** from snagging, direct collision, or crushing along the first exterior surface **112** and second exterior surface **114**, which are expected to be the front and back of the carrier device **100** in typical use and thus are expected to see the highest likelihood of contact and striking with other objects. The binding member **120**, when taut, urges the lateral edges **152** of the first panel **132** toward the lateral edges **153** of the second panel **134** to maintain frictional engagement of the inward sides **133** and **135** with an inserted magazine or other carried article.

(51) Retention of an inserted magazine **50** or other article, such as a tactical light, a knife, or other gear item is assured against unintended removal by the frictional engagement provided to the interior of the carrier device **100** by the taut binding member **120** that urges the edges of the first panel **132** and second panel **134** together. The semirigid panels and side members **204** of the bracket **200**, cooperatively acting with the binding member **120** as a self-adjusting frame, prevent closure of the opening **110** to maintain access to the interior of the carrier device **100** and assure the carrier device, when empty, is ready to rapidly receive an article such as a magazine. This is beneficial over, for example, a soft-walled pouch surrounded by a cinching cord, which may collapse when emptied, and may gather at its opening to delay withdrawal of an enclosed magazine at a critical moment. As shown in FIG. **1**C, the terminal end **206** of each side member **204** extends beyond the terminal ends **142** and **144** of the body member **130**, in the assembled carrier device, to better present the upper ends of the ramped inward contact surfaces **108** of the frame members and guide the magazine into the opening **110**. This is advantageous in that the corresponding greater dimension of a typical magazine having a rectangular cross section as represented in FIG. **4** first engages the ramped inward contact surfaces **108** of the frame members **204** when entering the carrier device.

(52) The magazine **50** particularly shown in FIG. **1** is for ammunition typically used in a semiautomatic handgun, and thus the carrier device **100** and its components of FIGS. **1**A-**5** can be

described as suited for use with a pistol without limitation as to other uses. In other embodiments, a carrier device can be used for ammunition magazines typically used in a semiautomatic rifle.

(53) The bracket **400** of FIG. **6** can be used, for example, in a carrier device for a rifle magazine. Descriptions above of the bracket **200** of the carrier device **100** apply as well to the bracket **400**, as denoted by same reference numbers for same or similar features, differing by dimension or placement but providing same or similar function. The central base plate **402** of the bracket **400** is wider, as measured in the width dimension W (see FIG. **3**D) than the base plate **202** of the bracket **200** to accommodate the corresponding greater width of a magazine loaded with rifle ordinance relative to a pistol magazine.

(54) A carrier device utilizing the bracket **400** is accordingly laterally wider, relative to the carrier device **100**. The wider second panel **334** in FIG. **7**A, relative to the second panel **134** of the carrier device **100**, has more area and accordingly more mounting holes **164** through the outwardly planar portion of opposite its recess **356**. As in the carrier device **100**, the arrangement pattern of the holes **164** in the second panel **334** of the carrier device **300** matches hole patterns in accessories such as a mounting strap attached similarly as to the carrier device **100** in FIG. **1**C.

(55) The wider body member **330** of the carrier device, relative to the body member **130** of the carrier device **100**, accommodates additional rigidifying features. The first panel **332** is further contoured by longitudinally extending inward grooves **340** (two in the illustrated embodiment) along the exterior surface (FIG. **7**A), such that multiple (three in the illustrated embodiment) outward high portions are defined. A central high portion **364** has mounting holes **164** for attachment of or to other articles.

(56) Longitudinal ridges **354** extend inward from the inward side **333** of the first panel **332** (FIG. **7**B) materially opposite and corresponding to the inward grooves **340** along the exterior surface. These further add rigidity and provide frictional engagement with a magazine or other article within the carrier functionally similar to the ridges of the carrier device **100**. The inward side **335** (FIG. **7**B) of the second panel **334** has an inside recess **356** defined between its lateral edges, and several inward extending contact bosses **360** to provide further frictional engagement with a magazine or other article on an opposite side of the article relative to the ridges **354** of the first panel **332**.

(57) The first panel **332** has an opposing first pair **194** of hooks **170** proximal the first terminal end **302** and an opposing second pair **196** of hooks **170** proximal the second end **304** longitudinally spaced from the first pair. The second panel **334** has an opposing pair of hooks **170**, referenced in the drawings as the third pair **198** rearwardly offset from, and longitudinally positioned between, the first pair **194** and second pair **196** in the assembled carrier device **300**. The hooks **170** of the carrier device **300**, in cooperation with the binding member **120**, provide the same of similar function as those described above with reference to the carrier device **100** such the above descriptions apply as well to both carrier devices.

(58) The above-described body members and brackets, and similar embodiments within the scope of these descriptions and referenced drawings, can be injection molded of thermoset plastic that, when set, is durable, semi-rigid, and resilient to flexures. The above expressly described embodiments, and others within the scope of these descriptions and drawings, are advantageous over hard-shell carriers having fixed dimensions. By use of the brackets as described above, nested with a folded hard-shell body member and assembled with a binding member, hard-shell benefits as to protection of a carried article and a persistently open entry are provided with a degree of size flexibility and article retention by internal friction.

(59) In other embodiments, brackets are semi-rigid, and resilient, whereas the body members are made of, or include, fabric or other flexible or pliable material as in the carrier device **500** of FIGS. **10**A-**10**C. By use of a semi-rigid and resilient bracket, pliable walls can be used while avoiding the shortcomings of prior-art soft-walled pouches that, for example, may collapse when emptied, and may gather where an opening is cinched by a shock cord. By use of the brackets as described

below, a carrier device can offer the flexibility of a partially soft-walled pouch having an entry held open by the resilient spring-like function of an approximately U-shaped bracket as described below. The below expressly described embodiments, and others within the scope of these descriptions and drawings, further benefit from the ramped-contact surfaces at the terminal ends of the side members of the U-shaped brackets that guide the entry of a magazine or other inserted article.

(60) The bracket **600** of FIG. **8** can be used, for example, in a carrier device **500** for a rifle magazine **60** as shown in FIGS. **10**A-**10**C. Opposite lateral side members of the assembled carrier device **500** are provided by the bracket **600**. The bracket **600** includes a central base plate **602** and, attached to opposite respective lateral ends of the base plate, a first lateral side member **604** and a second lateral side member **604** that extend parallel to each other in a same direction from the base plate. In the assembled carrier device **500**, the bracket **600** is nested within the body member **530** in the folded condition, with the exterior side of the base plate **602** of the bracket **600** abutting or proximate the interior side of the body member **530** at a central portion.

(61) Respective terminal ends **606** of the side members **604**, in cooperation with the terminal ends **542** and **544** of the body member **530**, define the first end **502** of the assembled carrier device **500**. A respective ramped inward contact surface **608** adjacent the terminal end **606** of each side member **604** of the bracket **600** defines a tapered opening **510** at the first end **502** of the assembled carrier device **500**.

(62) Each lateral side member **604**, along its laterally outward face, has longitudinally spaced (in the length dimension) pairs of parallel ribs, referenced in FIG. **8** as a first pair of ribs **610** proximal the terminal end **606**, a second pair of ribs **612** longitudinally spaced by a gap **611** from the first pair of ribs **610**, and a third pair of ribs **614** longitudinally spaced by a gap **613** from the second pair of ribs **612** and proximal to the base plate **602** end of the side member **604**. Each pair ribs of **610**, **612**, and **614** consists of two ribs that are spaced from each other front-to-back, in the width dimension, in that one rib of the pair extends along a front edge of the side member **604** and another rib of the pair extends along a back edge of the side member **604**. Thus a central space **618** extends along the exterior of the side member **604** between the ribs, where, for example, free ends **124** (FIG. **10**C) of the binding member **120** extending from the adjuster **126** can be conveniently held as in FIG. **10**C.

(63) The ribs **610**, **612** and **614** rigidify the side members **604** and provide guiding and retention of the binding member **120**. The ribs and gaps define alternating high portions (ribs) and low portions (gaps) to guide and stabilize the binding member **120** in a binding arrangement with portions of the binding member received in the gaps.

(64) Each lateral side member **604** has a loop **630** surrounding and defining a hole **632** for passage and retention of the binding member **120**, for example as shown in FIG. **10**C. The upper tip of the loop **630** defines the terminal end **606** of the side member **604**, and an interior face of the loop defines the ramped inward contact surface **608**. The laterally outward portion **636** of the loop **630** extends generally along the exterior of the side member **604**, thereby defining the hole **632** as an elongate slot. Outer edges of the loop **630** and ribs **610**, **612**, and **614** are generally beveled to minimize snagging or catching when carried with other gear.

(65) The loop **630** and hole **632** thereof are dimensioned to receive multiple binding lines, for example as shown in FIG. **10**C, in which the enlarged hole **632** at each lateral side of the carrier device **500** advantageously accommodates both the binding member **120** and the retention member **240**. In use, the retention member **240** is passed over the floor plate end **62** of the magazine **60** to further secure the inserted magazine in cooperation with the function of the binding member **120**, which tightens the device **600** around the magazine to apply frictional engagement as already described. A gripping tab **244** for manipulating the retention member **240** is shown in the illustrated embodiment of FIGS. **10**A-A user can stretch and position the member **240** over the end **62** of the magazine, for example by use of the gripping tab **244**, to secure the inserted magazine or pull the retention member **240** aside when the magazine is wanted for use or other removal.

(66) FIG. **9** shows an unfolded body member **530**, according to at least one other embodiment, for example for use in the carrier device **500** of FIGS. **10**A-**10**C with the bracket **600**. In use as shown, a magazine **60** is inserted into an open first end **502** of the device **500**. The open first end **502** may be for example oriented as upward in use. A second end **504** of the device, opposite the first end, is generally closed. At full insertion, a portion of the magazine **60** and the floor plate end **62** of the magazine extends outward from the first end **502** as available to be grasped and pulled from the carrier device **100**.
(67) An opening **510** (FIGS. **10**A-**10**C) into the interior of the carrier device **500** is defined between the terminal ends **542** (FIG. **9**, FIG. **10**A) and **544** (FIG. **9**, FIG. **10**B) of the body member **530**. Advantageously ramped inward contact surfaces **608** (FIG. **8**) guide the magazine **60** into the opening **510** and thus into the interior of the carrier device **500**. As shown in FIGS. **10**A and **10**B, the terminal end **606** of each side member **604**, extends beyond the terminal ends **542** and **544** of the body member **530**, in the assembled carrier device, to better present the upper ends of the ramped inward contact surfaces **508** and guide the magazine into the opening **510**.
(68) A first exterior side of the carrier device **500** may be generally directed outward when the carrier device is mounted on a host structure, and can thus be nominally termed the front side **512**. (FIG. **10**A). A second exterior side, opposite the front side **512**, would be generally directed toward such a host structure, and can thus be nominally termed the back side **514**. A mounting strap, for example attached to the back side **514**, may be provided as an accessory for attaching the carrier device **500** to a host structure. Front and back are nominal terms referring to some expected uses of the carrier device **500** without limiting the carrier device in its construction or use.
(69) Retention of the magazine **60** by the carrier device **500** against unintended removal, for example as a user or gear on which the device is mounted moves about, is assured by the elastically self-adjusting performance of the carrier device. A binding member **120** is stretched between the front side **512**, and back side **514** of the device **500**, crossing and capturing the lateral sides of the device **500** defined by the lateral side members **604** of the bracket **600**. This adjustably circumferentially tightens the device around the magazine to maintain frictional engagement. This frictionally secures an inserted magazine while permitting sliding entry and removal of the magazine by force applied by hand at the outward extending end of the magazine.
(70) The exterior front side **512** and opposite exterior back side **514** of the carrier device **500** in the illustrated embodiment are defined by the outer surfaces of corresponding sections of the single body member **530**, which in the illustrated embodiment, is a flexible and foldable rectangular assembly having pliable components constructed of flexible pliable materials such as durable fabric and pliable band portions. The body member **530** is folded in the assembled device **500** (FIG. **10**A). A first section **532** of the body member **530** defines the front side **512** of the assembled carrier device **500**, and a second section **534** of the body member defines a back side **514** of the assembled carrier device **500**. The sections **532** and **534** extend in opposite directions from a central section **546** of the body member **530** in the unfolded configuration of the body member **530** (FIG. **9**). In the assembled carrier device **500** (FIG. **10**C), the central section **546** is configured to form a one hundred and eighty degree turn as multiple bends, folds, or a U-turn or smooth arc as shown. This positions the sections **532** and **534** as generally parallel and extending in a same direction from the central section **546**.
(71) A sectioned member **536** of pliable material is mounted to the outward side of the first section **532**, for example by stitching. The sectioned member **536** has multiple band portions **538** defined between slots **539**, such that the band portions **538** act as loops to receive and retain respective portions of the binding member **120**. Similarly, pliable bands **540** are mounted to the outward side of the second section **534**, for example by stitching, such that the pliable bands **540** act as loops to receive and retain respective other portions of the binding member **120**. Border strips **544** that strengthen outer lateral edges **542** of the body member **530** are attached to the main body section **532**, for example by stitching. FIGS. **10**A-**10**C show an exemplary binding arrangement for the

binding member **120**. Each user may utilize the illustrated arrangement or others according to usage and preferences that may vary.
(72) The bracket **700** of FIG. **11** can be used, for example, in a carrier device for a pistol magazine. Descriptions above of the bracket **600** of the carrier device **500** apply as well to the bracket **700**, as denoted by same reference numbers for same or similar features, differing by dimension or placement but providing same or similar function. The central base plate **702** of the bracket **700** is not as wide (measured between the opposing side members **704** in the width dimension) as that of the bracket **600** (sized for a rifle magazine) to accommodate the corresponding lesser width of a magazine loaded with pistol ordinance. The lengths of the side members **704** (measured in the length dimesion from the base plate **702** to the terminal ends **606**) may vary from the lengths of the side members **604** according to magazine lengths and their bullet-count capacities. The bracket **700** can be assembled with a correspondingly dimensioned embodiment of the body member **530** to constitute, together with a binding member **120**, a carrier device for a pistol magazine.
(73) Similarly, the bracket **800** of FIG. **12** can be used, for example, in a carrier device for a pistol magazine with extended bullet-count capacity. Descriptions above of the bracket **600** of the carrier device **500** apply as well to the bracket **800**, as denoted by same reference numbers for same or similar features, differing by dimension or placement but providing same or similar function. The central base plate **802** of the bracket **800** is not wide as that of the bracket **600** (FIG. **8**) to accommodate the corresponding lesser width of a magazine loaded with pistol ordinance relative to a rifle magazine. The lengths of the side members **804** (measured in the length dimension from the base plate **802** to the terminal ends **606**) are greater than those of the side members **704** (FIG. **11**) to accommodate higher bullet-count capacity magazines. The bracket **800** can be assembled with a correspondingly dimensioned embodiment of the body member **530** to constitute, together with a binding member **120**, a carrier device for a pistol magazine with extended bullet-count capacity.
(74) Particular embodiments and features have been described with reference to the drawings. It is to be understood that these descriptions are not limited to any single embodiment or any particular set of features, and that similar embodiments and features may arise or modifications and additions may be made without departing from the scope of these descriptions and the spirit of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A carrier device comprising: a body member comprising a first section and a second section connected to and disposed a distance from the first section, the first section and second section each having a respective terminal end; a bracket comprising a first lateral side member and a second lateral side member connected to and disposed a distance from the first lateral side member, the first lateral side member and second lateral side member each having a respective terminal end, the bracket further comprising a slot disposed adjacent to the terminal end of at least one of the first and second lateral side members, wherein the slot has a length disposed between an exterior surface the respective lateral side member and a laterally outward portion connected to and extending away from the terminal end of the respective lateral side member, wherein an interior of the carrier device is defined between the first section and second section of the body member and between the first lateral side member and second lateral side member; and a binding cord releasably engaging hooks disposed on at least one of the first section and the second section, a portion of the binding cord disposed through the slot.
2. The carrier device of claim 1, the terminal end of each of the first lateral side member and second lateral side member are disposed in a plane above that passing through the terminal ends of the first and second sections.
3. The carrier device of claim 1, wherein the terminal ends of the lateral side members and the terminal ends of the first section and second section of the body member together define an

opening into the interior of the carrier device.

4. The carrier device of claim 3, further comprising a retention member disposed between the first lateral side member and second lateral side member across the opening for retaining a magazine when inserted into the carrier device.

5. The carrier device of claim 3, wherein the respective terminal end of each lateral side member comprises a ramped inward contact surface such that the opening into the interior of the carrier device is tapered.

6. The carrier device of claim 5, wherein the respective terminal end of each of the first section and second section of the body member comprises a ramped inward contact surface.

7. The carrier device of claim 5, wherein the portion of the respective lateral side member to which the laterally outward portion is connected defines the terminal end of the respective lateral side member.

8. The carrier device of claim 7, wherein the laterally outward portion comprises a tip end opposite that connected at the terminal end of the respective lateral side member, wherein the tip end is disposed adjacent the exterior surface of the respective lateral side member.

9. The carrier device of claim 8, wherein the laterally outward portion tapers between the terminal end of the respective lateral side member and the tip end of the laterally outward portion.

10. The carrier device of claim 8, wherein the tip end is connected to the exterior surface of the respective lateral side member.

11. The carrier device of claim 1, wherein the at least a portion of the hooks include a tooth extending from a portion thereof for engaging the binding cord.

12. The carrier device of claim 1, wherein at least one of the laterally outward portion and one of the hooks comprises a tooth extending from a portion thereof.